

FREE READER BONUS

Hosting Guide

& Party Plans

Which candles to make for every occasion, what to serve alongside, and how much to make for your crowd.

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A COMPANION TO

The Edible Candles Cookbook

Every candle in these plans is a recipe from the book; page numbers point you right to it.

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BEFORE THE PARTY

Plan Your Table

How many candles to make, how to set them out, and what to check for guests with allergies.

HOW MANY CANDLES?

Every recipe in the book serves 6 to 8 people. Recipes that make two or three small candles still serve 6 to 8 in total, so count the set as one candle.

GUESTS	CANDLES
2 to 4	1 candle. Or make a recipe with three small candles, light one, and keep the rest for another day.
6 to 8	1 candle
10 to 16	2 candles: one savory, one sweet
18 to 24	3 candles
25 to 32	4 candles, spread down the table

The Milk Chocolate Hazelnut Candle (p. 57) is the exception: it makes two candles that serve 8 to 10.

Spread them out
On a long table, set one candle at each end so everyone has a warm pool within reach.

SETTING THE TABLE

- Set each candle on a sturdy, heatproof plate with a rim, on a clear, steady surface.
- Put the dippers in bowls next to the candle. Each recipe lists its favorites under *Dip with*, and the plans in this guide repeat them so you can shop from one page.
- Keep the candle far from napkins, paper decorations, and anything else that can catch fire.
- Have a long lighter at hand, and leave room in the fridge for leftovers.

GUESTS WITH ALLERGIES

- Each candle in this guide shows what it contains, taken from the recipe in the book. Dippers have their own labels, so check those too.
- Need something without dairy? The Plant-Based Garlic Herb (p. 85), Bacon Fat & Black Pepper (p. 86), Coconut Lime (p. 87), Cocoa Butter Vanilla (p. 88), and Dairy-Free Dark Chocolate (p. 89) candles are made without butter.
- For more swaps, see *Dairy-Free, Vegan & Allergy Swaps* (p. 22).

BEFORE THE PARTY

Your Hosting Timeline

Most candles are made ahead, so the day of the party is mostly about lighting them.

Up to 5 days ahead

Check the *Keeps* line on each recipe. Most candles keep 3 to 5 days in the fridge, and many freeze for 1 month.

- Cheese and bacon candles: up to 2 days ahead.
- Brie, blue cheese, and pumpkin: fill them up to 1 day ahead.
- Garlic or herbs in oil: always in the fridge, for no more than 4 days.

The day before

Make any candles still on your list: they need about 3 hours in the fridge to set firm, a little longer for a few. Shop for the dippers.

On the day

A few finishing touches are added the same day: the caramel drip on the Salted Caramel Butter Candle, the coconut nest on the Easter Carrot Cake Candle, the piped border on the Birthday Cake Candle, the cookie crumbs on the Halloween candle, the olives on the Za'atar & Olive candle, and the torn bread around the Herb Butter & Bread Centerpiece.

Just before guests dip in

- Set the candle on its heatproof plate and let it stand about 10 minutes. Coconut oil candles are the exception: they go straight from the fridge to the table.
- Decorations go on now, once the surface feels slightly tacky.
- Trim the wick to about ½ in, or about 1 in for cheese candles, and light it.

While it glows

Dip around the edges of the pool, away from the flame. Blow the candle out when the pool gets low, when little ones are at the table, or whenever you leave the room, even for a minute.

Within 2 hours

Perishable candles go back in the fridge: every cheese candle and anything made with bacon, fresh garlic, fresh herbs, or fresh fruit. On a hot day above 90°F (32°C), make it 1 hour.

The last bite

The wick isn't edible. Remove it, and any other non-edible parts, before serving the last of the candle.

PARTY PLANS

Holidays Through the Year

Thanksgiving

A savory candle for the rolls, a sweet one for brunch, and pie you can dip.

SAVORY

Thanksgiving Sage & Cranberry Candle p. 91
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Warm dinner rolls, cornbread squares, roasted sweet potato wedges

SWEET

Maple Pecan Butter Candle p. 45
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy, pecans

DIP WITH
Buttermilk pancakes, warm cornbread, roasted sweet potato wedges

SWEET

Pumpkin Spice Candle p. 92
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Gingersnaps, sliced apples, graham crackers
A real little pumpkin is the holder. Fill it up to 1 day ahead.

Crowd & timing: All three serve 18–24. Make the cranberry candle up to 2 days ahead; it's a perishable one, so it goes back in the fridge within 2 hours.

Christmas & Winter Holidays

Brie on the cheese board, orange and cardamom at brunch, peppermint for dessert.

SAVORY

Brie & Cranberry Cheese Candle p. 73
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Crisp apple slices, gingersnaps, toasted baguette rounds
Spoon it back into its rind up to 1 day ahead.

SWEET

Cardamom Orange Butter Candle p. 48
3 small candles · serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Cranberry scones, cardamom buns, clementine segments

SWEET

Peppermint Bark Candle p. 94
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Salted pretzel rods, chocolate wafer cookies, marshmallows

Crowd & timing: All three serve 18–24. The cardamom and peppermint candles keep 3 to 5 days, so make them early in the week.

Holiday Cookie Swap

Let the cookies do the dipping.

SWEET

Gingerbread Candle p. 93
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Soft molasses cookies, pear slices, toasted raisin bread

SWEET

Candy Cane White Chocolate Candle p. 95
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Sugar cookies, fresh strawberries, salted pretzel rods

SWEET

Cookie Butter Candle p. 53
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy, wheat, soy

DIP WITH
Graham crackers, sliced bananas, mini waffles

Crowd & timing: All three serve 18–24, and they all freeze for 1 month: make them whenever you have a free afternoon.

New Year's Eve

A grazing board for the evening, then something sweet at midnight.

SAVORY
Grazing Board Trio p. 105
3 small candles · serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy, sesame

DIP WITH
Seeded crackers, aged cheddar cubes, red grapes

SAVORY
Truffle & Sea Salt Butter Candle p. 41
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Hand-cut fries, brioche toasts, wild mushroom crostini

SWEET
New Year's Champagne Butter Candle p. 96
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Fresh raspberries, shortbread cookies, toasted brioche fingers
Light it as midnight approaches. The champagne is simmered into a syrup, but the candle isn't alcohol-free.

Crowd & timing: All three serve 18–24. Everything keeps 3 to 5 days in the fridge.

Easter Brunch

Spring flavors, and a carrot cake candle the kids will find first.

SAVORY
Herbed Goat Cheese Candle p. 72
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Seeded crackers, cucumber rounds, sugar snap peas

SWEET
Easter Carrot Cake Candle p. 99
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy, walnuts

DIP WITH
Spice cake cubes, pineapple chunks, ginger cookies
Roll it in its coconut nest the same day.

SWEET
Lavender Honey Butter Candle p. 50
2 small candles · serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Lemon shortbread, fresh blackberries, warm cream scones

Crowd & timing: All three serve 18–24. Little ones at the table? Blow the flame out first; everyone can still dip.

Mother's Day Tea

Pressed flowers, pistachio, and a lemony dome for a long afternoon.

SWEET
Cocoa Butter Vanilla Candle p. 88
serves 6–8 · Contains: no dairy

DIP WITH
Strawberries, graham crackers, toasted marshmallows

SWEET
Pistachio White Chocolate Candle p. 68
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy, pistachios

DIP WITH
Fresh figs, dried apricots, almond cookies

SAVORY
Lemon Ricotta Cheese Candle p. 78
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Grilled bread, blistered cherry tomatoes, asparagus spears

Crowd & timing: All three serve 18–24. The cocoa butter candle keeps up to 1 week, so make it first.

Fourth of July Cookout

Smoky, cheesy, and red, white, and blue.

SAVORY

Bacon Fat & Black Pepper Candle p. 86
serves 6–8 · Contains: no dairy

DIP WITH
Skillet cornbread, roasted potato wedges, grilled corn

SAVORY

Cheddar & Jalapeño Butter Candle p. 80
3 small candles · serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Tortilla chips, cornbread squares, mini bell peppers
Three little candles to spread along the snack table.

SWEET

Fourth of July Berry Candle p. 100
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Shortcake biscuits, fresh blueberries, grilled peach slices

Crowd & timing: All three serve 18–24. On a hot day above 90°F (32°C), perishables come back inside within 1 hour.

Halloween Party

A spooky dirt-cup candle, with something smoky for the grown-ups.

SWEET

Halloween Pumpkin-Spice Chocolate Candle p. 98
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy, wheat, soy

DIP WITH
Crisp apple slices, mini pretzel twists, orange segments
Easy enough for kids to help. Add the cookie crumbs when you serve.

SAVORY

Smoked Gouda Butter Candle p. 75
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Soft pretzel bites, roasted fingerling potatoes, apple wedges

Crowd & timing: Both serve 12–16. Little ones at the table? Blow the flame out first; everyone can still dip.

Game Day

The Big Game

Four candles down the snack table, for a crowd that won't sit still.

SAVORY

Game Day Buffalo Candle p. 102
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Celery sticks, carrot sticks, crispy chicken wings
Light it before kickoff.

SAVORY

Bacon & Chive Butter Candle p. 40
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Soft pretzel bites, baked potato wedges, cheddar biscuits

SAVORY

Pimento Cheese Candle p. 79
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy, eggs

DIP WITH
Butter crackers, celery sticks, pickled okra

SWEET

Peanut Butter Cup Chocolate Candle p. 63
3 small candles · serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy, peanuts

DIP WITH
Green apple slices, pretzel twists, crispy rice treat squares
Three oversized cups; don't count on leftovers.

Crowd & timing: All four serve 24–32. The bacon and pimento candles keep up to 2 days, so make those last. Blow the candles out at halftime if everyone heads to the TV.

Taco Night

Smoky lime for the chips, chili chocolate for dessert.

SAVORY

Smoky Chipotle Lime Butter Candle p. 33
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Tortilla chips, grilled corn wheels, warm flour tortillas

SWEET & SPICY

Chili Chocolate Candle p. 64
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Salted tortilla chips, plantain chips, grilled pineapple spears

Crowd & timing: Both serve 12–16 and keep at least 3 days in the fridge.

PARTY PLANS

Date Night

Dinner for Two

Something to share with a glass of wine, and something sweet after.

SAVORY

Blue Cheese & Fig Candle p. 74
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Pear slices, rye crisps, dried apricots
Bold blue cheese and fig, made for wine night. Fill it up to 1 day ahead.

SWEET

Valentine's Strawberry Heart Candle p. 97
3 small candles · serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Brownie bites, pound cake fingers, fresh cherries
Three little hearts: light one tonight and keep the others in the fridge for up to 3 days, or freeze them for 1 month.

Crowd & timing: One candle is plenty for two. Leftovers go back in the fridge within 2 hours.

After-Dinner Coffee

Bring it out with the espresso.

SWEET

Mocha Espresso Chocolate Candle p. 59
3 small candles · serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Almond biscotti, cinnamon churro bites, chocolate wafers
Served right in espresso cups.

SWEET

Brown Sugar & Bourbon Butter Candle p. 49
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Grilled peaches, oatmeal cookies, warm gingerbread
Made with bourbon extract, so there's no liquor near the flame, but it isn't alcohol-free.

Crowd & timing: Pick one. Both keep 3 to 5 days, so make them on the weekend.

Galentine's Night

Pink, pretty, and made for a table of friends.

SWEET

Valentine's Strawberry Heart Candle p. 97
3 small candles · serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Brownie bites, pound cake fingers, fresh cherries

SWEET

Strawberry Rose Butter Candle p. 47
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Shortbread fingers, ripe raspberries, toasted brioche

SWEET

White Chocolate Raspberry Candle p. 58
3 small candles · serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Vanilla wafers, fresh raspberries, angel food cake cubes

Crowd & timing: All three serve 18–24, and they all freeze for 1 month.

More Reasons to Gather

Weekend Brunch

Bagels, cinnamon rolls, and a fruit platter, all in candle form.

SAVORY
Everything Bagel Butter Candle p. 30
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy, sesame

DIP WITH
Toasted mini bagels, cucumber rounds, cherry tomatoes

SWEET
Brunch Cinnamon Roll Candle p. 103
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Mini pancakes, waffle sticks, crisp bacon strips

SWEET
Vanilla Bean Butter Candle p. 46
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Fresh strawberries, pound cake cubes, warm madeleines

Crowd & timing: All three serve 18–24 and keep up to 3 days in the fridge.

Birthday Party

A classic savory candle, little cupcake candles, and a cake you can make a wish on.

SAVORY
Garlic & Herb Butter Candle p. 26
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Warm sourdough, garlic knots, roasted baby potatoes

SWEET
Blueberry Lemon Butter Candle p. 51
3 small candles · serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Lemon poppy seed muffins, vanilla wafers, fresh blueberries

SWEET
Birthday Cake Candle p. 101
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Mini vanilla cupcakes, animal crackers, banana slices
Make a wish, blow out the flame, then everyone dips in. Pipe the border the same day.

Crowd & timing: All three serve 18–24.

Bridal or Baby Shower

Light, fresh, and pretty in pink.

SAVORY
Lemon, Dill & Caper Butter Candle p. 36
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Poached shrimp, smoked salmon on rye, steamed asparagus

SWEET
Lavender Honey Butter Candle p. 50
2 small candles · serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Lemon shortbread, fresh blackberries, warm cream scones

SWEET
White Chocolate Raspberry Candle p. 58
3 small candles · serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Vanilla wafers, fresh raspberries, angel food cake cubes

Crowd & timing: All three serve 18–24. The lavender and raspberry candles freeze for 1 month.

Dinner Party

Light the first candle with the antipasti and the last one with coffee.

SAVORY

Basil Pesto Butter Candle p. 38
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy, pine nuts

DIP WITH
Fresh mozzarella cubes, ciabatta toasts, grilled shrimp
Light it before the pasta course.

SAVORY

Parmesan & Rosemary Cheese Candle p. 76
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Breadsticks, warm focaccia squares, roasted cherry tomatoes
Light it while the lasagna bakes.

SWEET

Mint Chocolate Candle p. 61
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Brownie bites, vanilla meringues, chocolate sandwich cookies

Crowd & timing: All three serve 18–24.

Summer Patio

Backyard flavors, and a tropical trio that smells like vacation.

SAVORY

Sun-Dried Tomato & Basil Butter Candle p. 31
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Ciabatta cubes, grilled zucchini, marinated artichoke hearts

SWEET

Coconut Dark Chocolate Candle p. 67
3 small candles · serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Pineapple chunks, mango spears, coconut macaroons

SWEET

Coconut Lime Candle p. 87
3 small candles · serves 6–8 · Contains: no dairy

DIP WITH
Pineapple spears, papaya slices, lime shortbread cookies
Keep it chilled and light it straight from the fridge.

Crowd & timing: All three serve 18–24. On a hot day above 90°F (32°C), perishables come back inside within 1 hour.

Wine & Cheese Night

A happy-hour spread built around the cheese board.

SWEET & SAVORY

Whipped Feta & Honey Cheese Candle p. 71
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Pita chips, sliced peaches, toasted baguette

SWEET

Honey & Thyme Butter Candle p. 43
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Warm buttermilk biscuits, sliced pears, aged cheddar

SAVORY

Olive Oil & Rosemary Butter Candle p. 82
serves 6–8 · Contains: dairy

DIP WITH
Torn ciabatta, warm pita, marinated olives
Pour the rest of the rosemary oil into a dish alongside for the bread.

Crowd & timing: All three serve 18–24. The feta candle keeps up to 2 days, so make it last.

YOUR TURN

My Party Plan

Print this page for your next gathering.

OCCASION _____ DATE _____

GUESTS _____ CANDLES NEEDED _____

CANDLES

CANDLE	PAGE	MAKE BY	DIPPERS TO BUY

SHOPPING LIST

ON THE DAY

- ☐ Heatproof plates with a rim
- ☐ Long lighter
- ☐ Bowls for the dippers
- ☐ Napkins away from the flame
- ☐ Room in the fridge for leftovers
- ☐ Finishing touches done
- ☐ Candles out 10 minutes before lighting